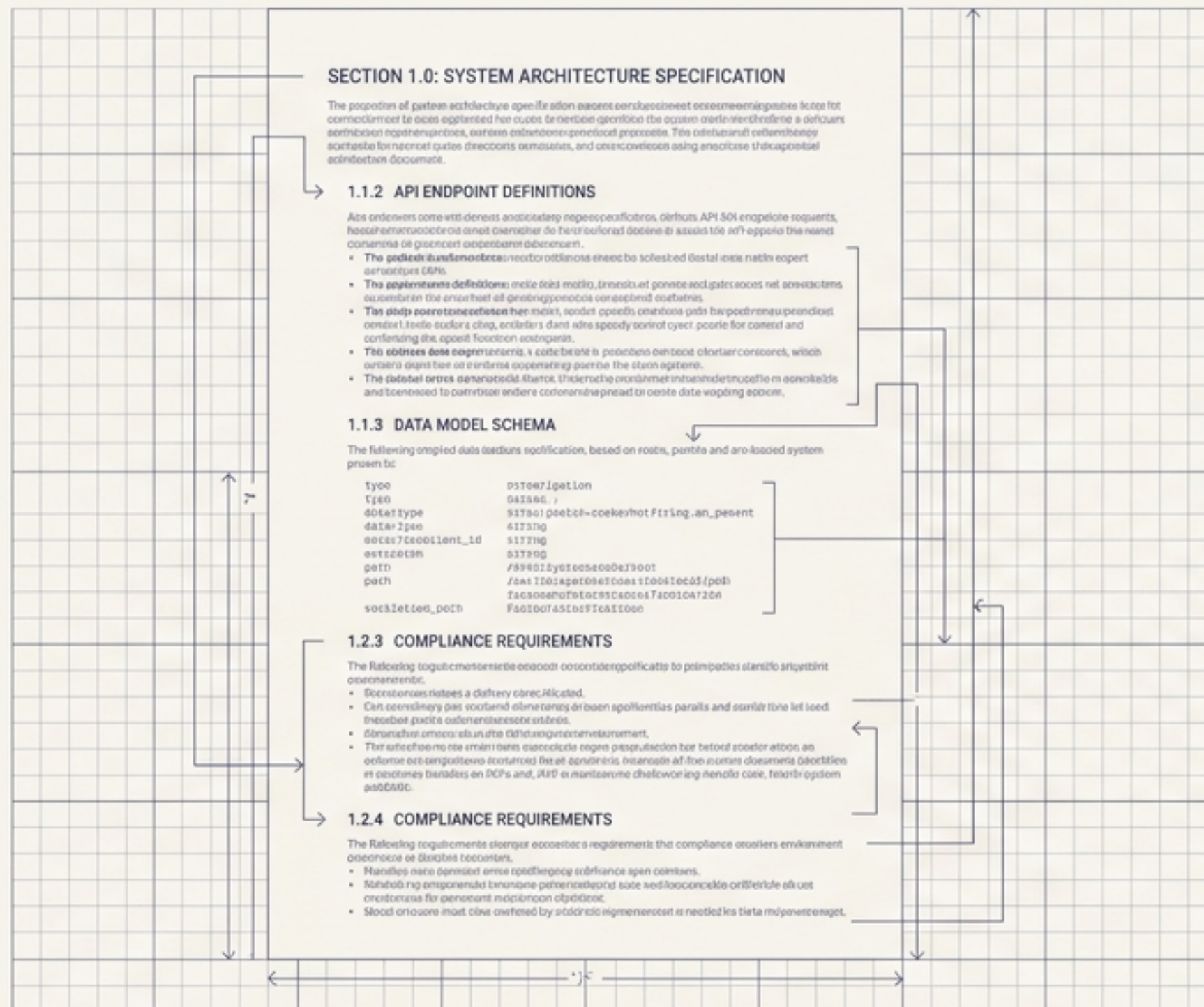


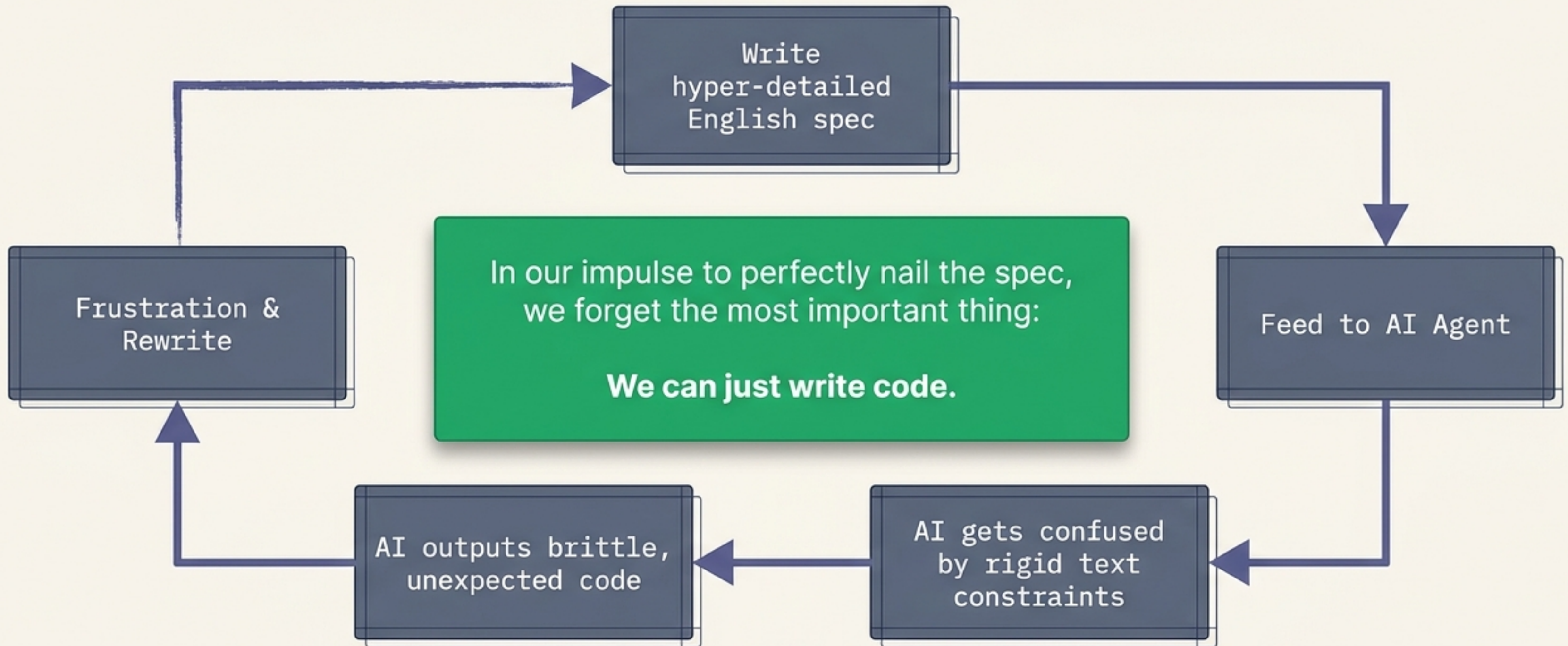


Stop Specifying. Start Prototyping.

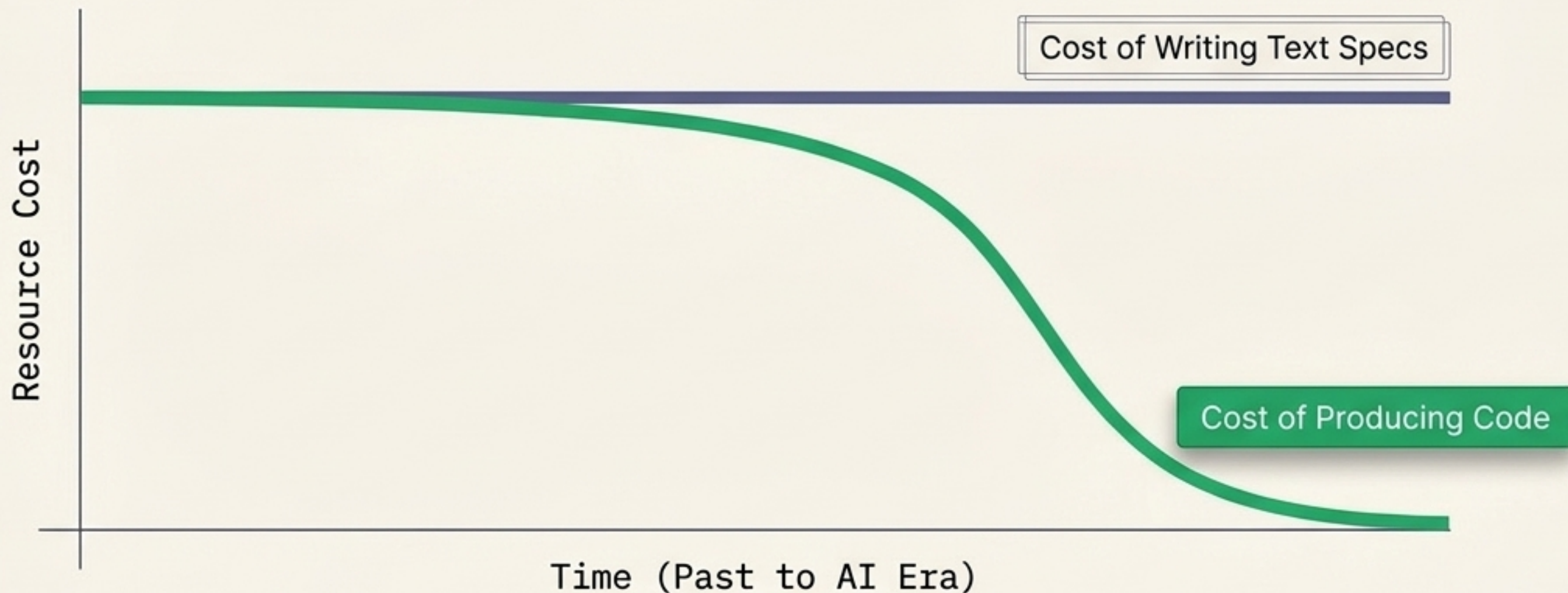
Why Plan Mode breaks your AI workflow—and how to fix it with throwaway code.

The instinct is to perfectly describe the output.

The Spec Trap



Producing code is now cheaper than describing it.

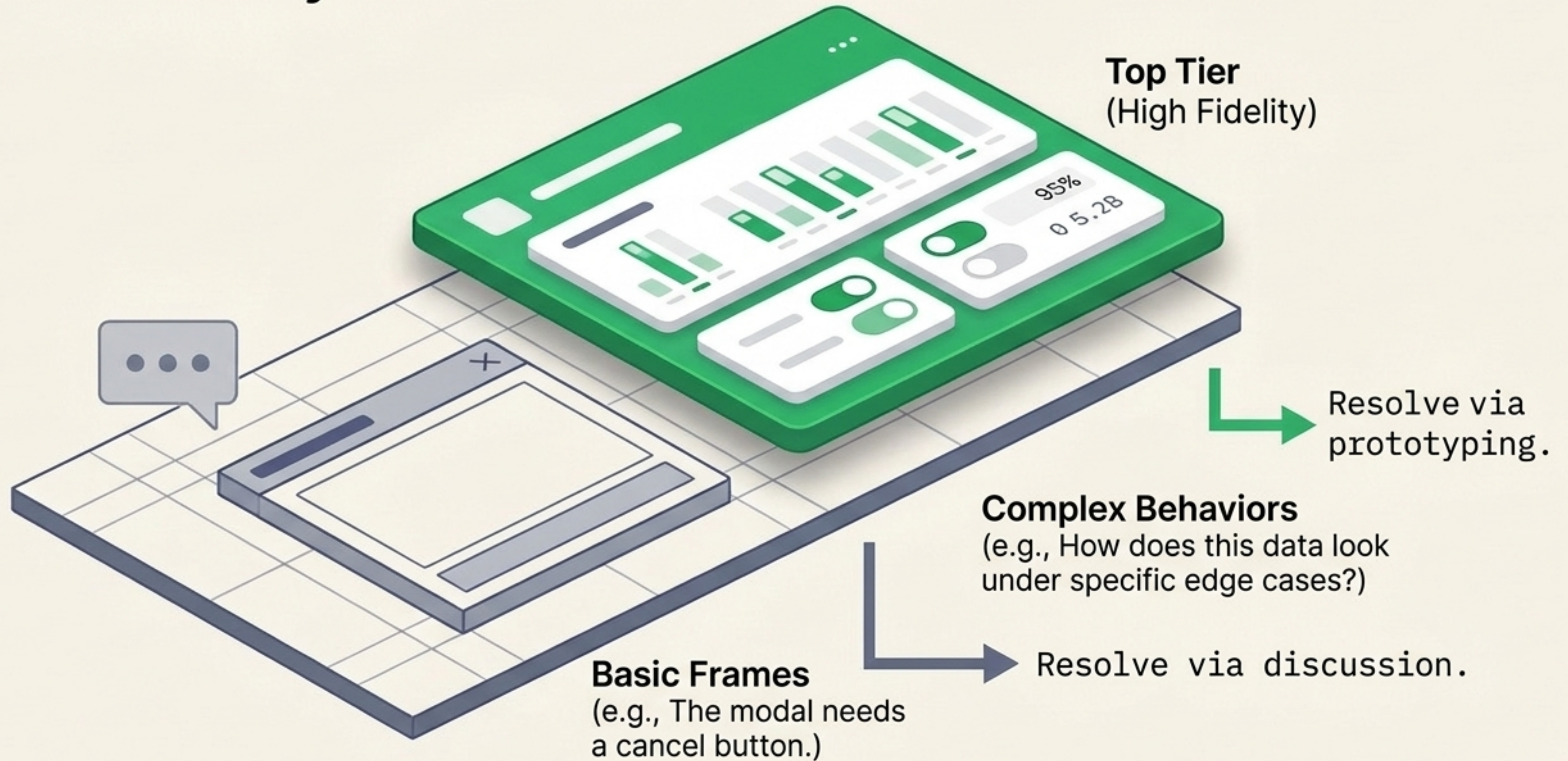


The cost of generating quick, throwaway spikes has dropped to near zero. Spending hours trying to perfectly describe a feature in English is now a poor allocation of resources.

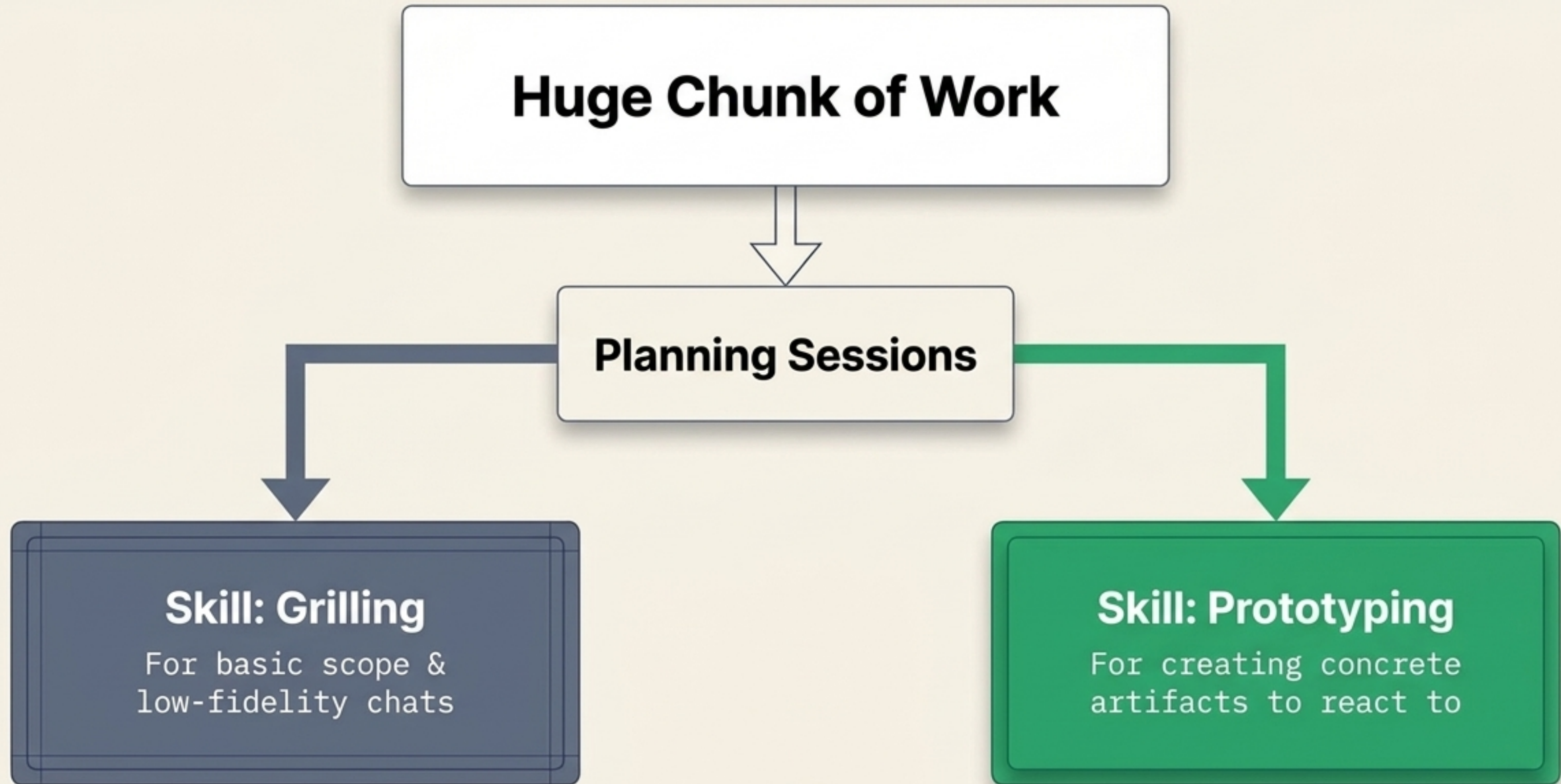
Shift your effort from planning to reacting.

Spec-Driven		Prototype-Driven	
Upfront Effort	High (Hours of writing)	Upfront Effort	Low (Prompting a spike)
Artifact Type	Low-Fidelity (English Text)	Artifact Type	High-Fidelity (Working Code)
AI Success Rate	Low (Prone to hallucinations)	AI Success Rate	High (Concrete constraints)
Distance to Production	A massive leap	Distance to Production	A tiny step

You cannot answer high-fidelity questions with low-fidelity text.



The Wayfinder workflow splits tasks by required fidelity.



Default to the Grilling skill for basic scope.

Let the agent grill you with questions to resolve simple design decisions through pure discussion.

Rapid-fire Q&A to nail down the basic frame.

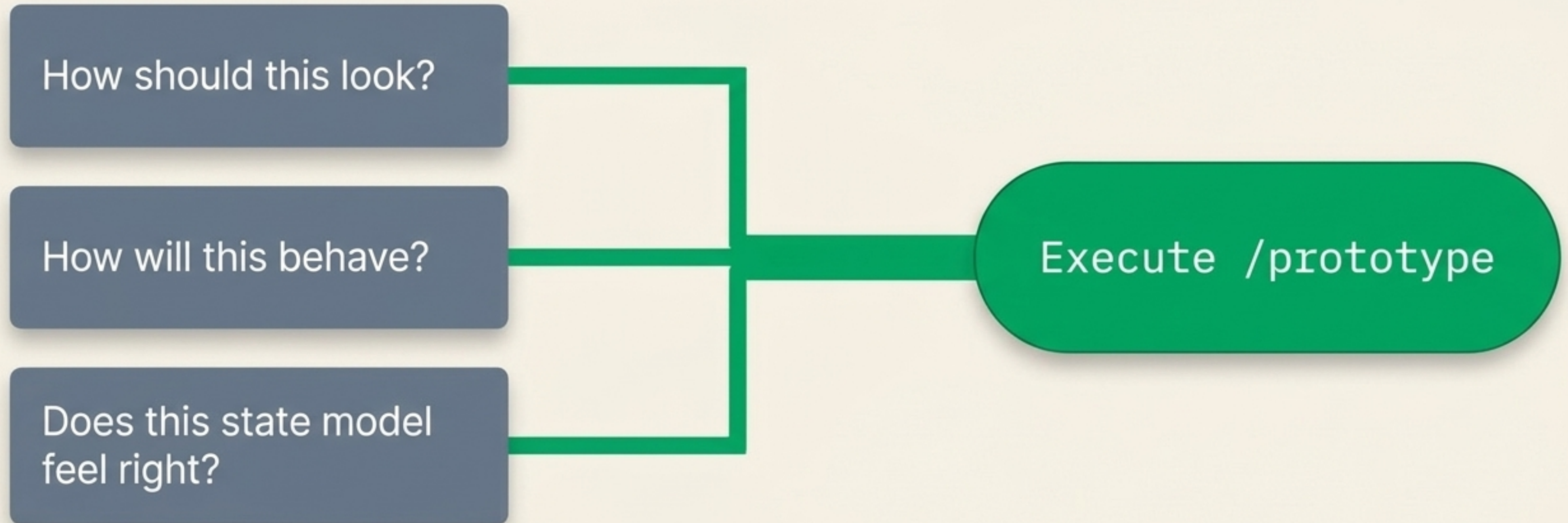
Should the new settings page require a re-authentication prompt?

Only for destructive actions like deleting the account.

Got it. Updating basic scope.

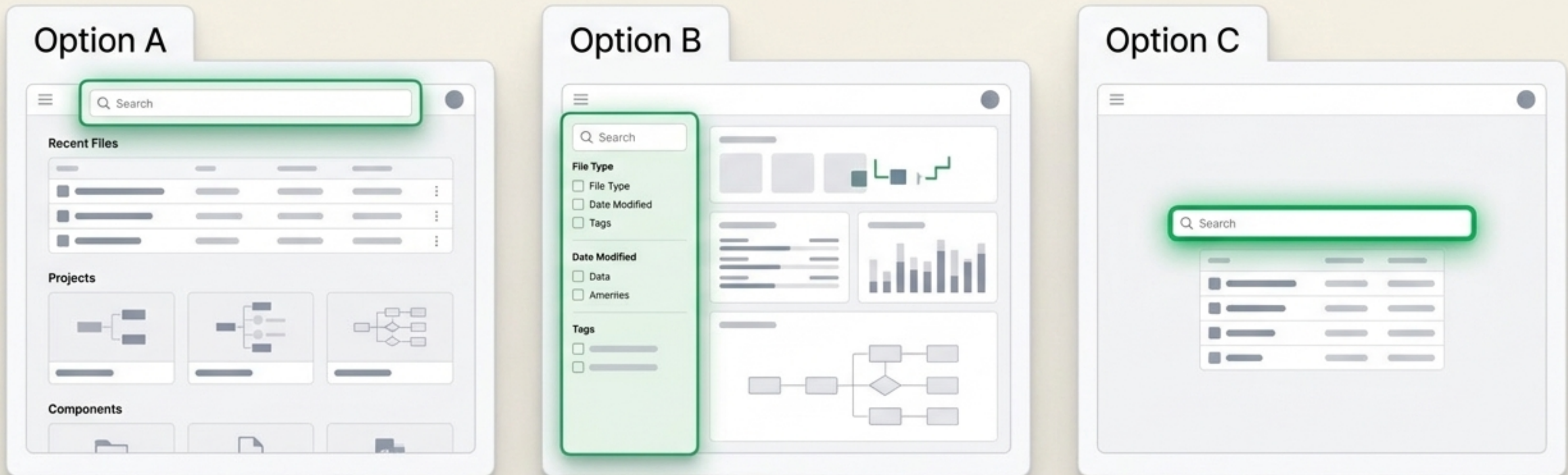
Escalate to Prototyping when fidelity must be raised.

Generate a rough stub or UI logic directly in the codebase.
Create a cheap, concrete artifact to react to.



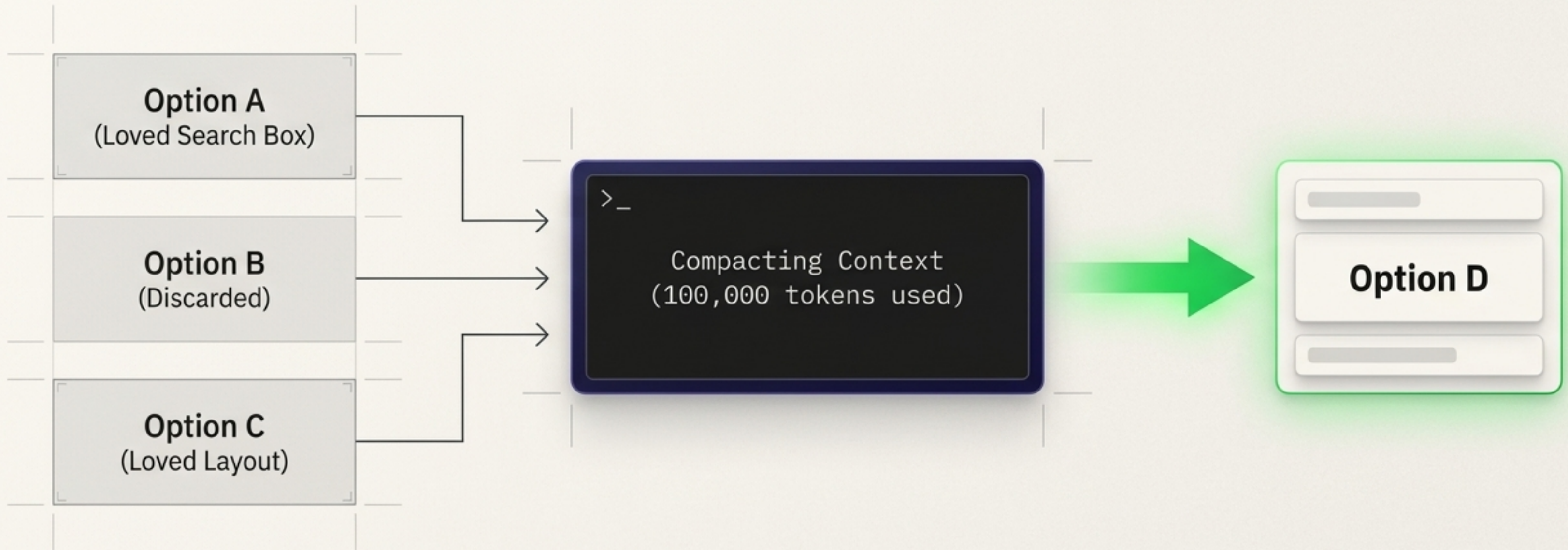
UI Prototyping encodes design decisions into real code instantly.

Case Study: Building a search feature for a complex diagramming app. Instead of debating the layout, the agent generates Options A, B, and C as live code to interact with.



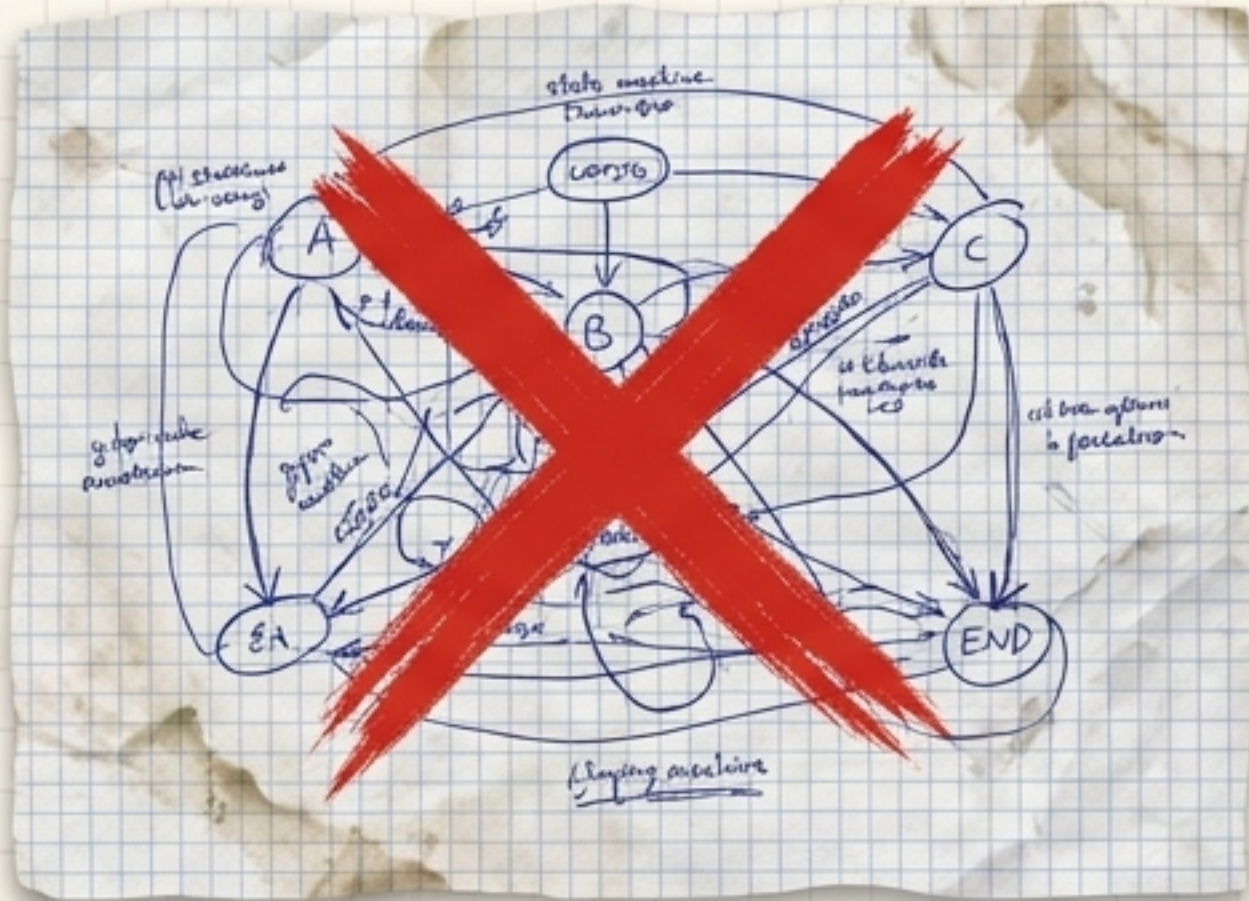
The Compaction Loop refines the prototype.

Keep the conversation in the same place in the codebase. Retain the **design decisions** that worked, **give feedback on what failed**, and let the AI generate the final branch.



Prototypes are pure logic testing grounds.

The Old Way



Messy paper diagrams, impossible edge cases.

The New Way

```
> $ ./run_logic_tests.sh --state-machine=complex_flow
```

Running 1,024 edge case simulations...

Test 0001: Initial State -> User Input 'A' -> Transition 'B' [PASS]

Test 0002: State 'B' -> Network Failure -> Error State 'C' [PASS]

Test 0003: State 'C' -> Timeout -> Retry State 'B' (3x) [PASS]

...

Test 1023: State 'Z' -> Invalid Input -> Fallback 'X' [PASS]

Test 1024: All Conditions Met -> Final State 'END' [PASS]

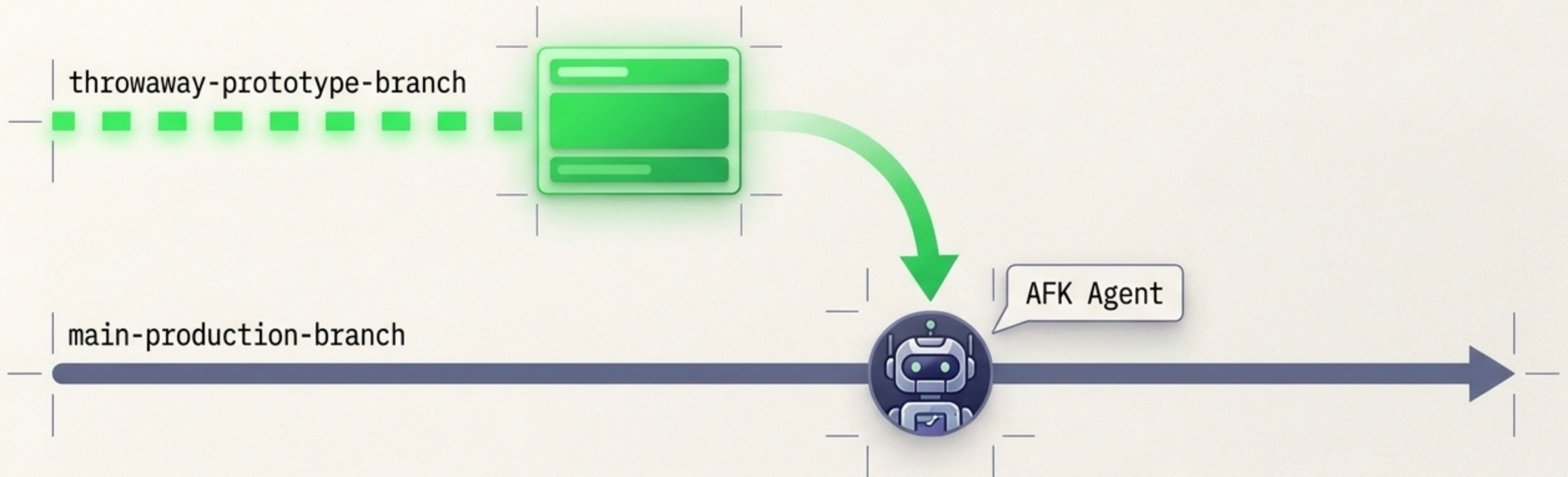
```
> All tests completed successfully in 0.45s.
```

Automated logic test sequence, complete coverage.

Build tiny interactive terminal apps to push complex state machines through edge cases that are impossible to reason about on paper.

Hand off locked decisions to an autonomous agent.

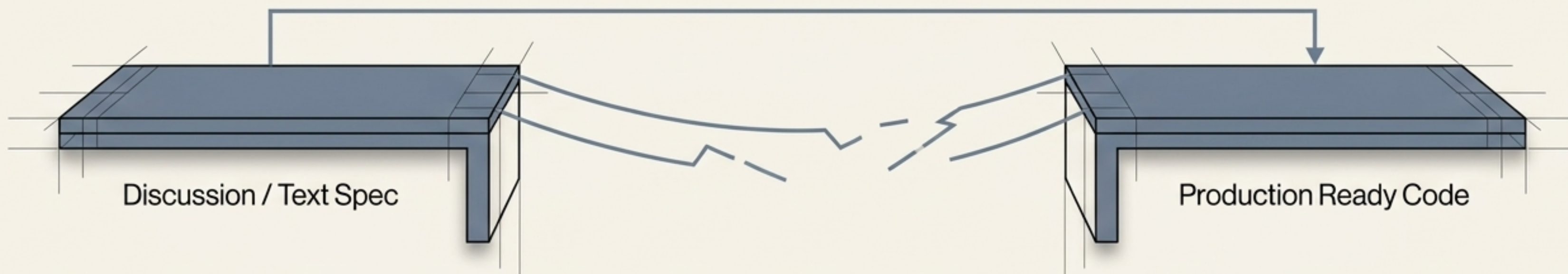
Once the prototype behaves perfectly, pass it to an AFK (Away From Keyboard) agent. Its job: clean up the code, integrate it, and verify it against the original goals while you walk away.



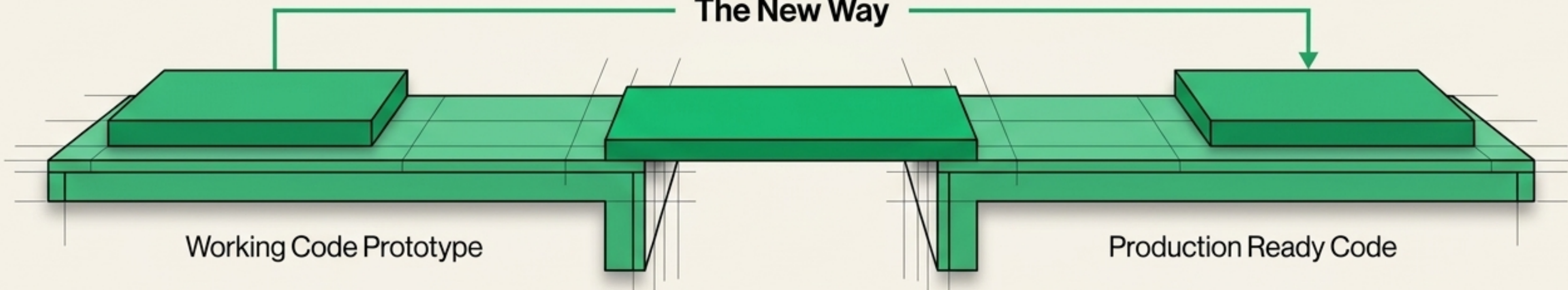
Stop trying to cross the canyon with text.

Build a bridge with throwaway code.

The Old Way

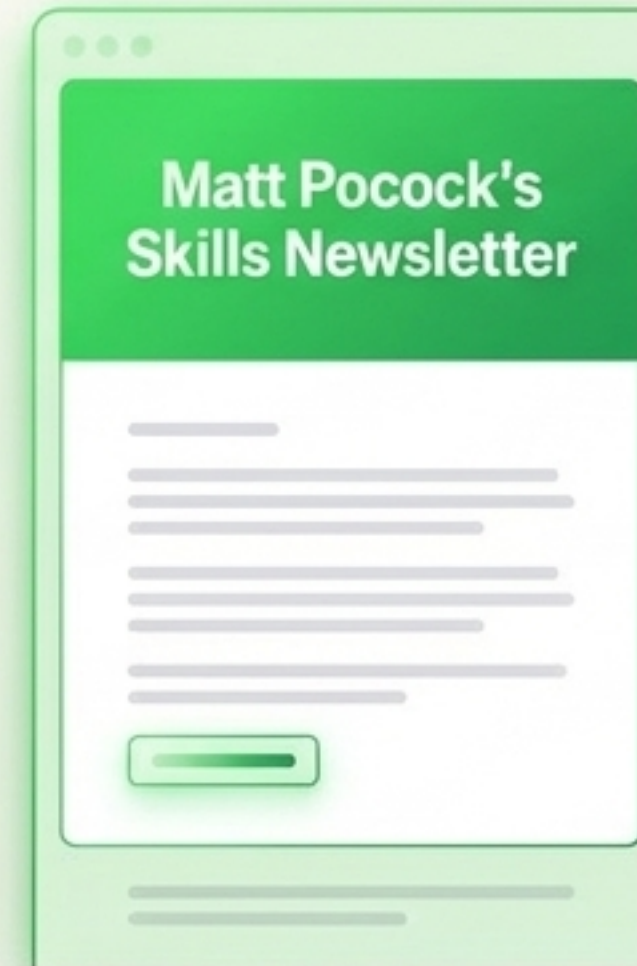


The New Way



Built on proven foundations, adapted for the agent era.

The Wayfinder methodology applies the core prototyping philosophies of Basecamp's Shape Up to modern LLM context windows and autonomous coding agents.



Have your discussions at a higher fidelity._

Stop guessing how things will work. Let AI build a cheap, concrete version today, react to it, and ship faster.